

Plan-Ahead Strategies for Healthy Eating



Scenario/Situation	Plan Ahead Strategies
Grocery Shopping	• Select recipes/meals and foods in advance. • Write a grocery list. • Use online shopping and grocery lists. • Avoid shopping at busy times. • Avoid shopping when hungry.
Dining Out	• Look at the menu ahead of time. • Call in advance to request accommodations. • Request substitutions or alternatives at the restaurant. • Have an idea of what to order ahead of time.
Parties/Holiday Events	• Let the host know in advance of any dietary restrictions. • Offer to bring a healthy dish. • Have a light snack prior to the event. • Set a drink limit ahead of time.
Travel	• Pack healthy, non-perishable snacks for the journey. • Research restaurants at the destination ahead of time. • Write out a list of healthy meals to stick to at restaurants. • Look up one or two local grocery stores at your destination. • Write a list of healthy foods to obtain at the local store and stock up on arrival.
Between Meal Snacks	• Write out a list of healthy snacks and stick to both, sweet and savory. • Prepare and pack snacks ahead of time for the week. • Keep a healthy snack (non-perishable) at your desk or in your bag for hunger emergencies.
Meal Delivery Services	• Review menus and nutrition information ahead of time. • Select restaurants that provide nutrient-dense options, such as vegetables, lean proteins, and whole grains. • Replicate meals that you might prepare at home rather than selecting calorically dense options. • Request modifications such as having oil, sauces, and dressings on the side to adjust the amount of added fats in meals.
Meal Subscription Services	• Select a subscription that aligns with your dietary and health goals and review the nutrient profile of meals prior to subscribing. • Review the nutrition information for meals prior to ordering.

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	• Add additional fresh/frozen vegetables to meals obtained through a subscription service, for more fiber and micronutrients.
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